

Europe's debate over how to boost clean manufacturing is about to heat up

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【要点】

- ・ EUは秋に「産業加速法」について議論し、クリーン製造業の強化を目指す但、加盟国間の保護主義と自由貿易のバランスについて対立している。
- ・ この法案は低炭素製品の公共調達割当と「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」ルールを導入し、中国などからの廉価な輸入品との競争から欧州メーカーを守ることを目的としている。
- ・ EUは製造業の経済に占める割合を現在の14%から2035年までに20%に引き上げ、産業基盤を強化し外国への依存を減らす野心を持っている。
- ・ 法案ではセメント5%、アルミニウム25%など戦略的セクターで低炭素製品の公共調達最小割当を設定しているが、鋼鉄には同様の厳しい規定がない。
- ・ フランスはより強い「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」保護を求める一方、輸出依存型のドイツは貿易相手国からの報復を懸念している。

【メール原文】

BRUSSELS — The European Union's long-held ambition to become a clean industrial powerhouse will face a major test this autumn, as lawmakers and member
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Europe's debate over how to boost clean manufacturing is about to heat up
By Ben Makuch · Aug 25, 2026, 6:00 AM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — The European Union's long-held ambition to become a clean industrial powerhouse will face a major test this autumn, as lawmakers and member countries debate the Industrial Accelerator Act.

The flagship industrial policy of Commission President Ursula von der Leyen's second term aims to stimulate climate-friendly manufacturing by introducing low-carbon public procurement quotas along with controversial "Made in Europe" rules.

First unveiled in March and now under review by the European Parliament and Council of the EU, the sprawling legislation is rooted in Mario Draghi's landmark report on European competitiveness. EU industry chief Stéphane Séjourné has described the proposal as a "change in doctrine" designed to shield European manufacturers from competing against cheaper and heavily subsidized imports from China and other major industrial economies.

At its core, the IAA attempts to bolster European manufacturing by accelerating the approval process for industrial projects and reducing administrative burdens that businesses often cite as barriers to growth. It also incentivizes low-carbon products that meet the Union-origin, or Made in Europe, criteria.

But the effort is already exposing a fundamental divide over just how far Europe should go to protect its own industry. France is pushing for stronger “Made in Europe” safeguards, while export-heavy Germany fears provoking retaliation from trading partners, according to three EU diplomats.

Industrial renaissance

For Séjourné and von der Leyen — who dropped the word “decarbonization” from the proposal’s original title — the legislation is intended to spark a broader industrial revival. Their ambition is to raise the sluggish manufacturing sector’s share of the EU economy to 20 percent by 2035, from roughly 14 percent today, while simultaneously strengthening Europe’s industrial base and reducing its dependence on foreign competitors.

The IAA offers significant incentives and foresees the creation of lead markets for low-carbon products in strategic sectors . Under the Commission’s proposal, certain public procurement projects would be required to meet minimum quotas for green products that are made in the EU — including 5 percent for cement and 25 percent for aluminum.

Steel, however, didn’t get the same deal. While the proposal includes a requirement that 25 percent of steel used in certain public projects be “low carbon,” it doesn’t stipulate it must be produced in the EU. (Nor has it, as industry watchers say, clearly defined what qualifies as low-carbon steel .)

That apparent slight has not gone unnoticed by Eurofer, the European steel lobby, which welcomed the proposal’s commitment to creating a lead market for green steel but says the Commission has not gone far enough.

“The direction of the IAA is correct, however, the current proposal falls short in its ambition creating demand signals for low-carbon steel made in the EU,” the lobby group said in a statement . “Without robust Union-origin requirements linked to steel originally melted and poured within the EU, public procurement and support schemes risk being met by imported steel, undermining decarbonization investments in Europe.”

According to people familiar with the Commission’s positioning on the IAA, European green steel quotas were left out of the proposal to avoid provoking the Trump administration, which sometimes fixates on steel , and India, which is a major steel exporter to the bloc.

But there are signs that Eurofer’s position is gaining traction. In a draft compromise circulated by the Council of the EU and obtained by POLITICO, member countries propose amending the IAA to require that “at least 25 percent of the total volume of steel used shall be low-carbon and of Union origin.”

Even if a compromise can be found on steel, the Council remains deeply divided over the overall legislation, according to three EU diplomats who spoke to POLITICO.

The split involves the bloc’s two economic giants . Germany, they say, has significant reservations about the IAA, while France, home to the proposal’s chief architect, Séjourné, has emerged as one of its staunchest defenders.

France sees the legislation as an opportunity to build stronger “Made in Europe” protections — something Washington has signaled it opposes , even as the U.S. pursues its own protectionist trade policies — and shield domestic manufacturers from heavily subsidized competition from China and elsewhere. Germany, on the other hand, worries protectionist measures might provoke retaliation

against its export-dependent economy.

That concern may no longer be theoretical. According to one lawmaker, foreign allies and trading partners are already expressing unease about some of the proposal's more protectionist elements.

"Prime ministers from all over the world are calling: 'Hey, I thought you wanted to be friends,' or 'I thought you were having a hard time with the U.S. and China,'" said the parliamentary insider.

Threading the needle

A recent compromise draft circulated by the Irish presidency of the Council of the EU proposes replacing the broad "Made in Europe" concept with a more legally precise system based on trade agreements and product-specific market access.

That draft compromise also proposes giving the Commission discretionary power to relax or abandon low-carbon quotas if the requirements are deemed to be pushing up the cost of materials and threatening European competitiveness. It could also use that power if the supply of "low-carbon" materials is limited, or if the rules are deemed to be damaging the EU's production capacity and threatening security of supply.

In Parliament, there will be no shortage of questions and debates surrounding the IAA. Three committees share responsibility for the file: Industry, Research and Energy; Internal Market and Consumer Protection; and International Trade.

But just as in the Council, the core political fight centers on how Europe should support an industrial base that must decarbonize to address climate change while remaining profitable. A more pro-industry coalition is taking shape among the center-right European People's Party — Parliament's largest group — the centrist Renew Europe, and the center-left Socialists & Democrats. Together, they have argued Europe that needs a more assertive industrial strategy to compete with China and the U.S.

The Greens, meanwhile, fear the IAA risks diluting the EU's climate ambitions by shifting the focus from decarbonization to industrial competitiveness.

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